2009 Toyota Prius

$2,395 · 172,000 miles · Private seller · Littlerock, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Craigslist

Listing: https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/littlerock-2009-toyota-prius-gets-over/pg2qbeMD2MhUAimoAovSmU

Report generated October 29, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$2,787	**$337**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 6 recalls · 502 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$2,395.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$221.54
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$15.57
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$32.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$2,787.11
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$2,787.11
Amount financed	$0.00
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$2,937.11

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$0.00
Insurance (estimate, liability)	$70.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 46 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$103.26
Maintenance & repair reserve	$150.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$13.80
Total per month	$337.06

Running costs without the loan: **$337/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$6,982** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

Gen-2 Prius drivetrain is very durable, but at 172k the original hybrid battery is near the end of its typical life, and the price reflects that.

NHTSA data for this model year: 6 recalls · 502 owner complaints (64 involving a crash). Most complaints: Service Brakes (199), Exterior Lighting (111), Hydraulic (91), Vehicle Speed Control (71), Electrical System (60), Electric (44).

Known issues for this model

• Hybrid battery degradation (~150-200k)

• Inverter coolant pump failure

• Burning oil / head gasket on high-mileage 1NZ-FXE

• Combination meter (dash display) going dark

• Brake actuator failure

Check on this car before buying

• Hybrid battery test (Dr. Prius life test)

• Watch dash for triangle warning / 'check hybrid system'

• Inverter coolant pump running (listen at hood with car READY)

• Oil level

• Registration back-fee amount and smog certificate

Notes

$2,395 'first $2,395 gets it', 172k mi, clean title, cold A/C, no hybrid-battery or warning lights per seller. Minor body imperfections. Posted 2026-10-12 - call to confirm it's still there (phone only, no texts).

REGISTRATION IS PAST DUE: ask the amount - CA back fees/penalties transfer to the buyer, so subtract them from your offer. Seller must provide a smog certificate.

Cheapest way onto a 46 MPG car: even if the hybrid battery needs a refurbished pack ($1,500-3,000), the total stays under the $4,300 Bakersfield Prius. Get a hybrid battery health test (Dr. Prius app + OBD dongle, or a hybrid shop) before paying.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.